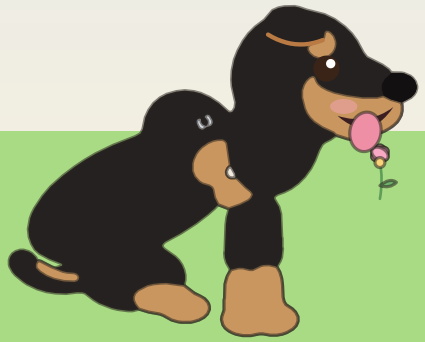
Tidbit and Sugarfoot's Big Picnic



This book belongs to

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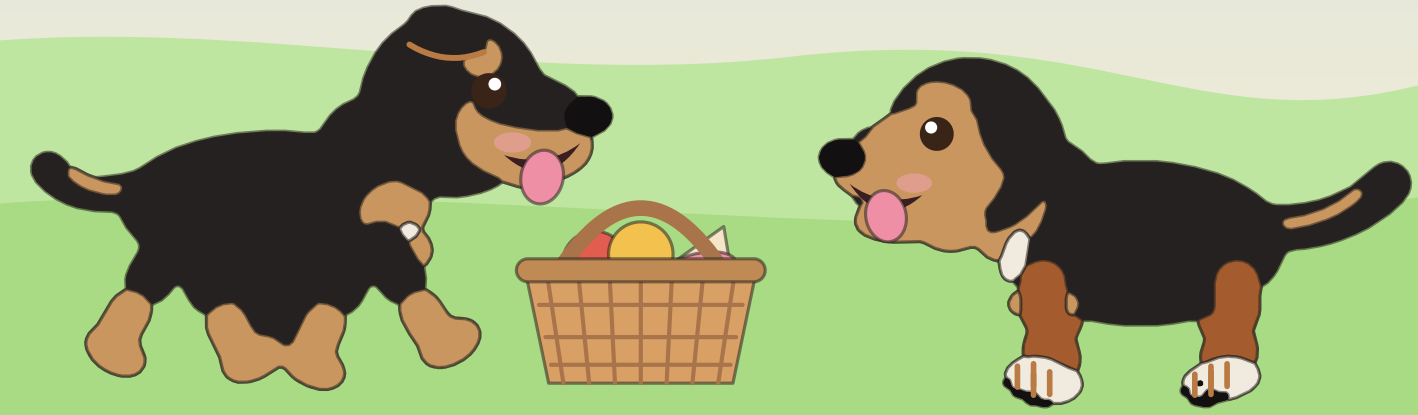




Tidbit and Sugarfoot's Big Picnic

A read-aloud story about big feelings, sharing the load and saying sorry

by Christian



Independently published
spreadloveandacceptance.com

The Frequency Buddies Books, Book 1: *Tidbit and Sugarfoot's Big Picnic*.
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The characters and the story are original to this site.

This is a story for sharing. It is general education about feelings and getting along, not a diagnosis or treatment, and it cannot know your child.

Set in Andika, Fraunces and Lora (SIL Open Font License).

Who is in this story



Tidbit



Sugarfoot



Professor Puddles



Ollie



Dot



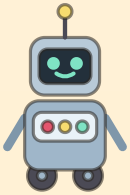
Hopper



Nutmeg



Lumi



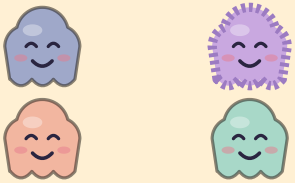
Beep



The ducklings

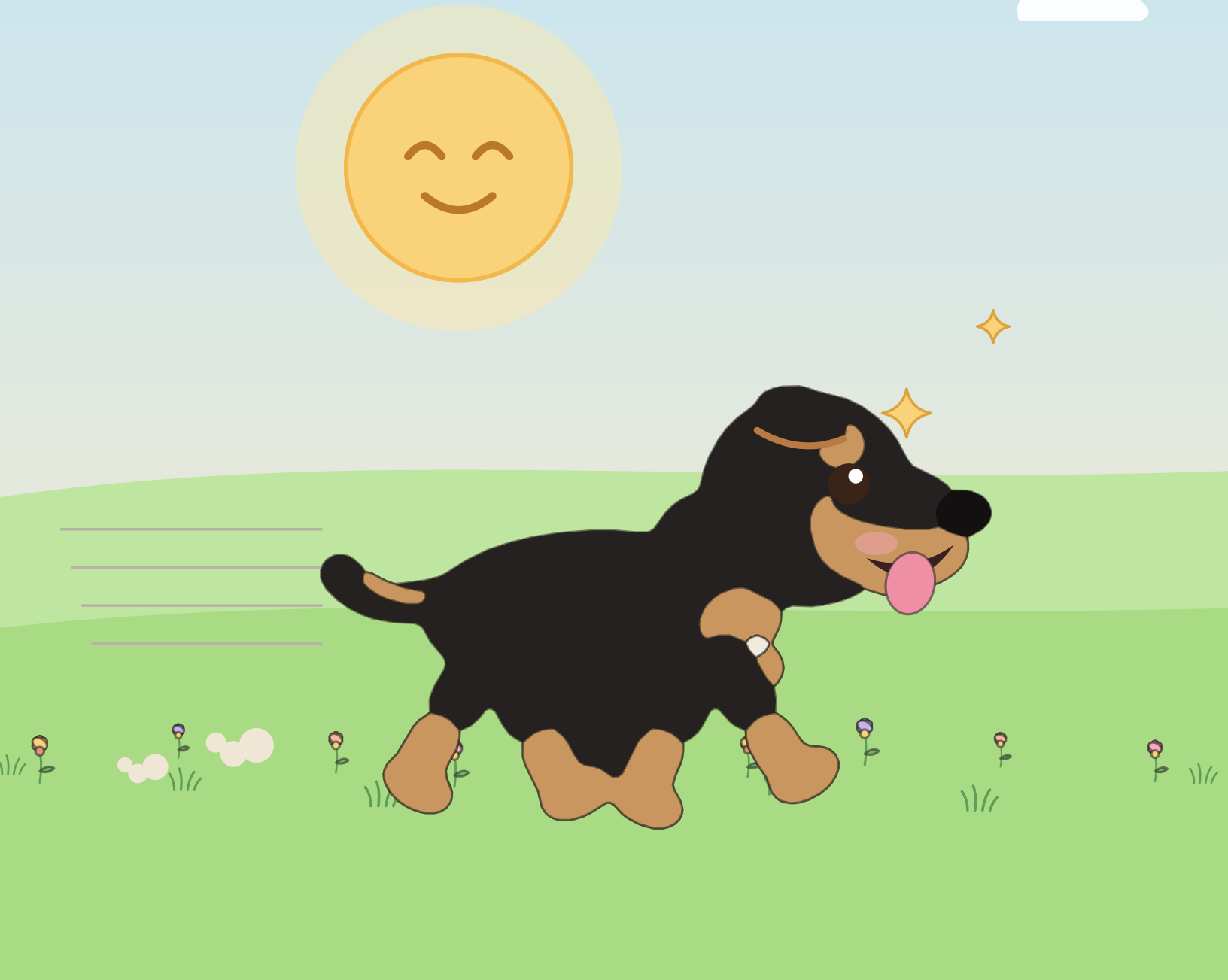


The Moon

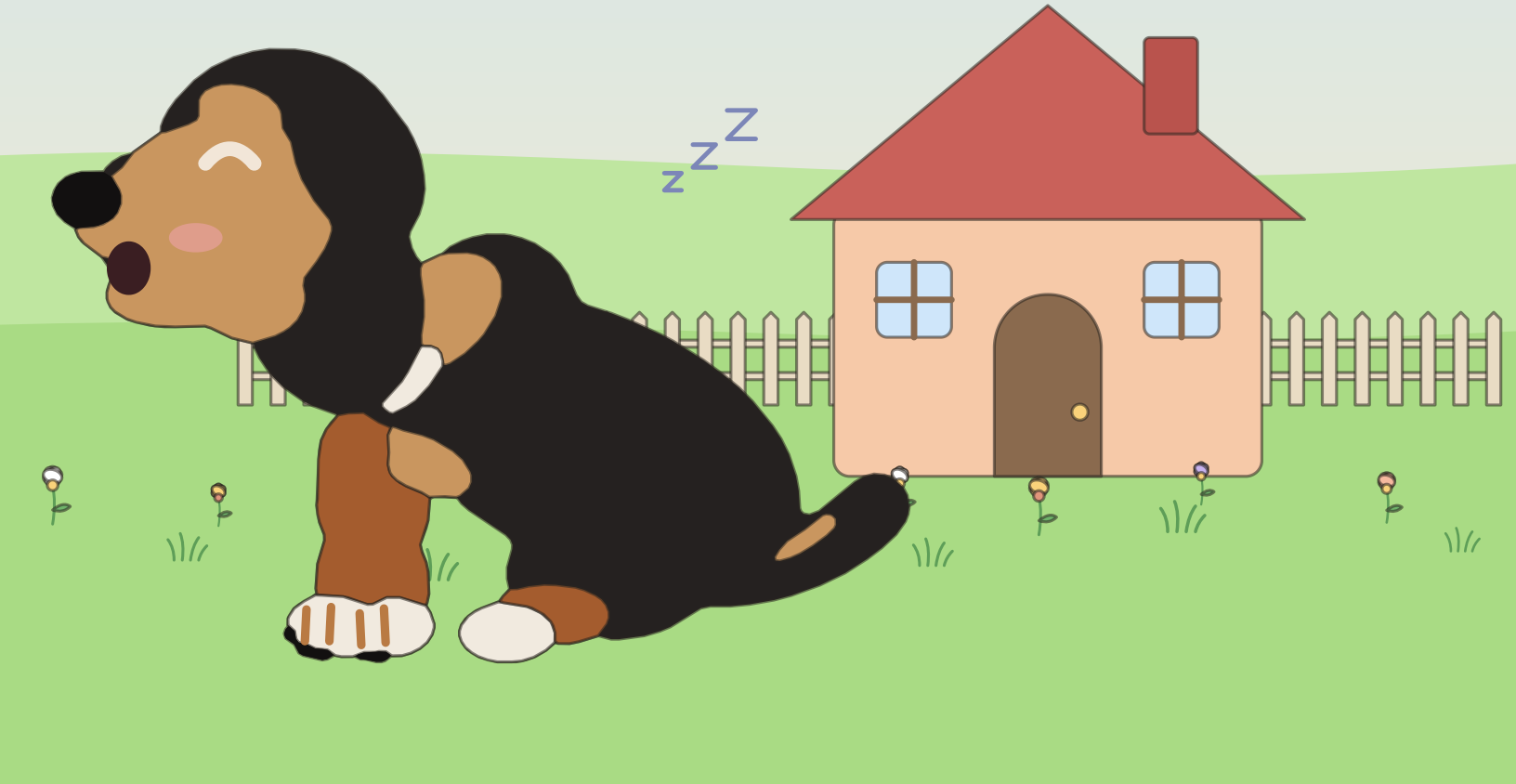


The Static clouds

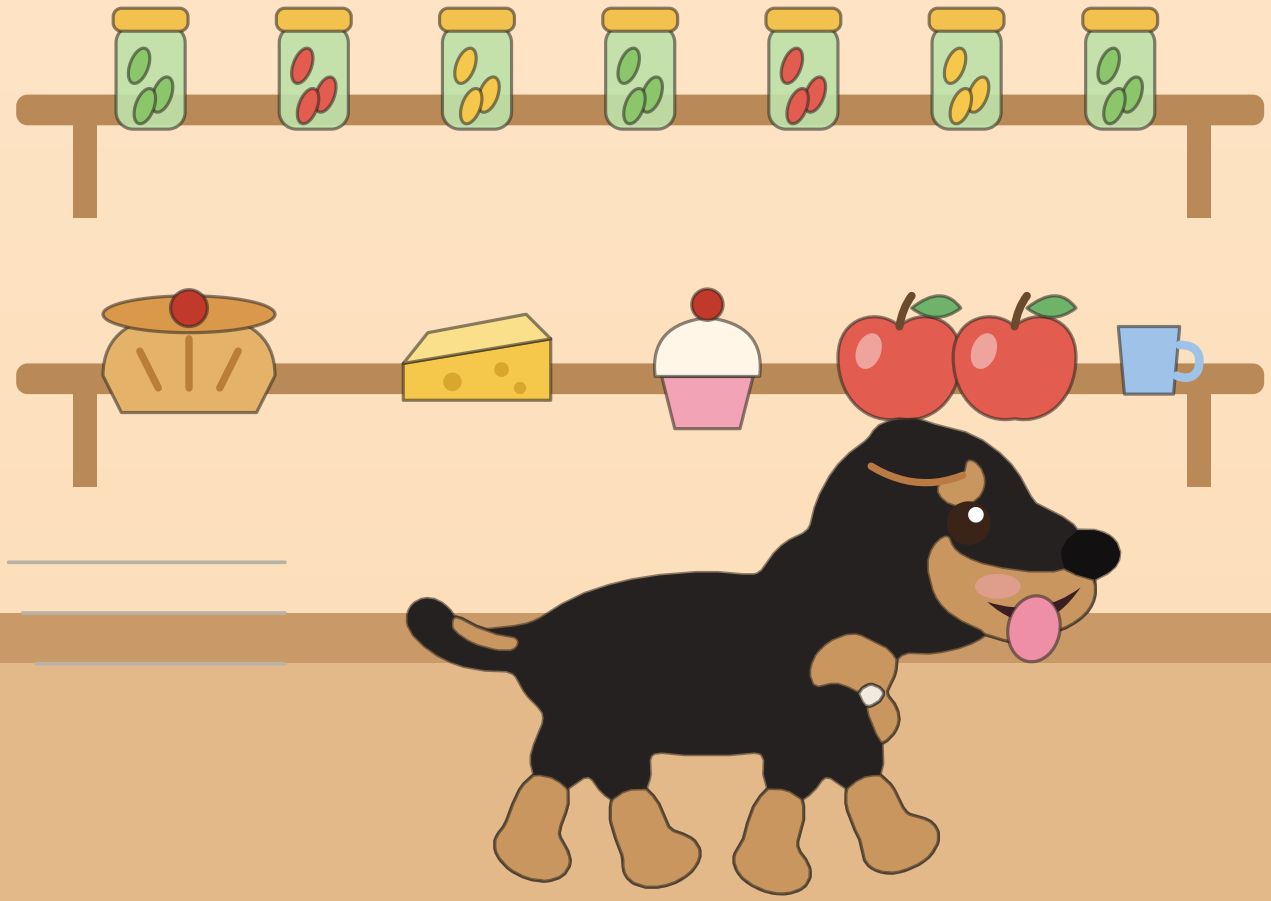
Tidbit woke up zoom, zoom, zoom,
and zipped around the living room.



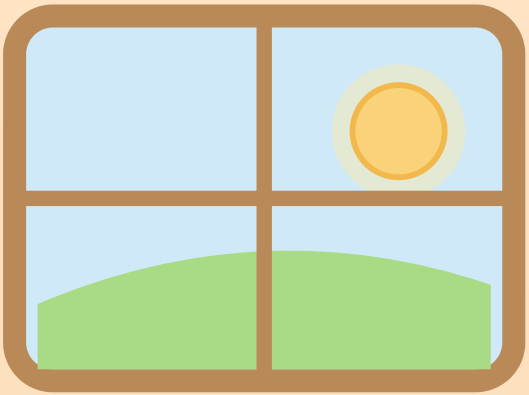
Sugarfoot woke up slow, slow, slow,
and stretched her paws from head to toe.



“Today is picnic day!” said Tidbit.
“The whole Hollow is coming. I will pack EVERYTHING!”

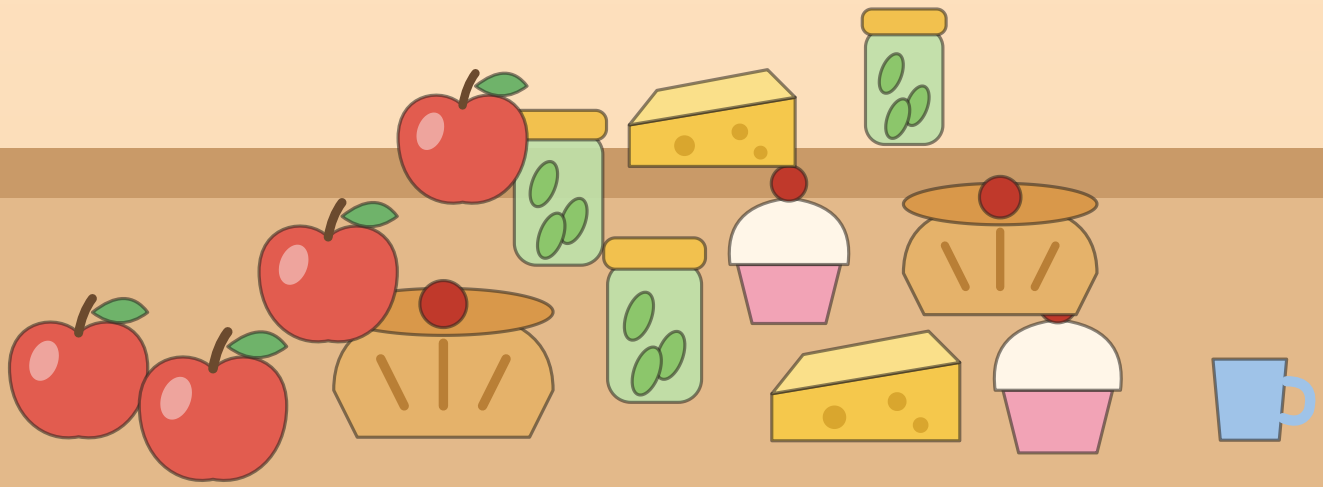


“Everything is a lot,” said Sugarfoot kindly.
“Shall we pack it together?”
But Tidbit was already zooming off to the pantry.





She packed the apples. She packed the pie.
She packed the pickles piled up high.
She packed the cheese and the cups and the cake,
until the basket was ready to break.

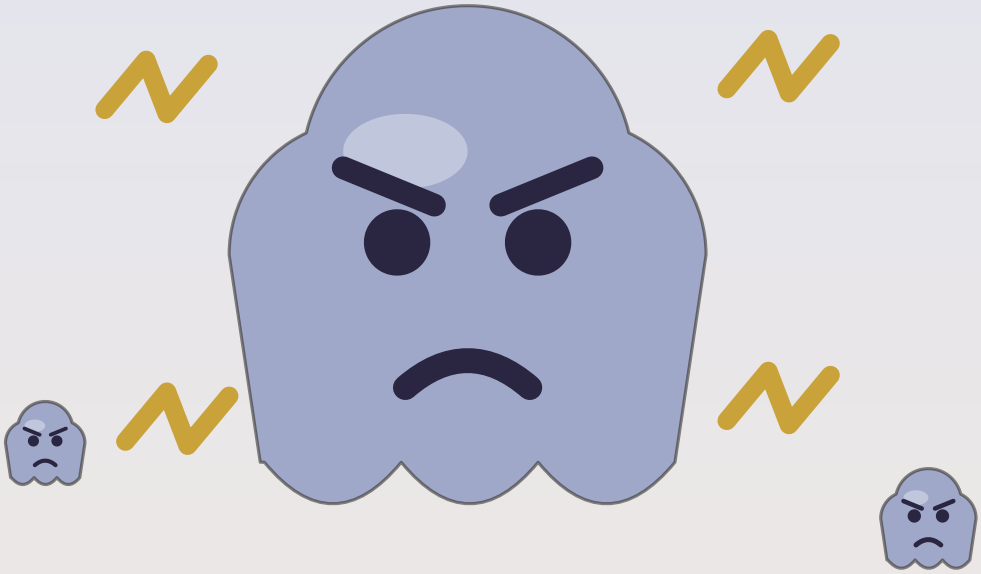


“I can carry it ALL by myself!” said Tidbit.
She tugged. She puffed. She wobbled.
The basket did not budge.



Tidbit's paws got buzzy.
Her ears got hot.
Her tummy got tight as a knotted-up knot.



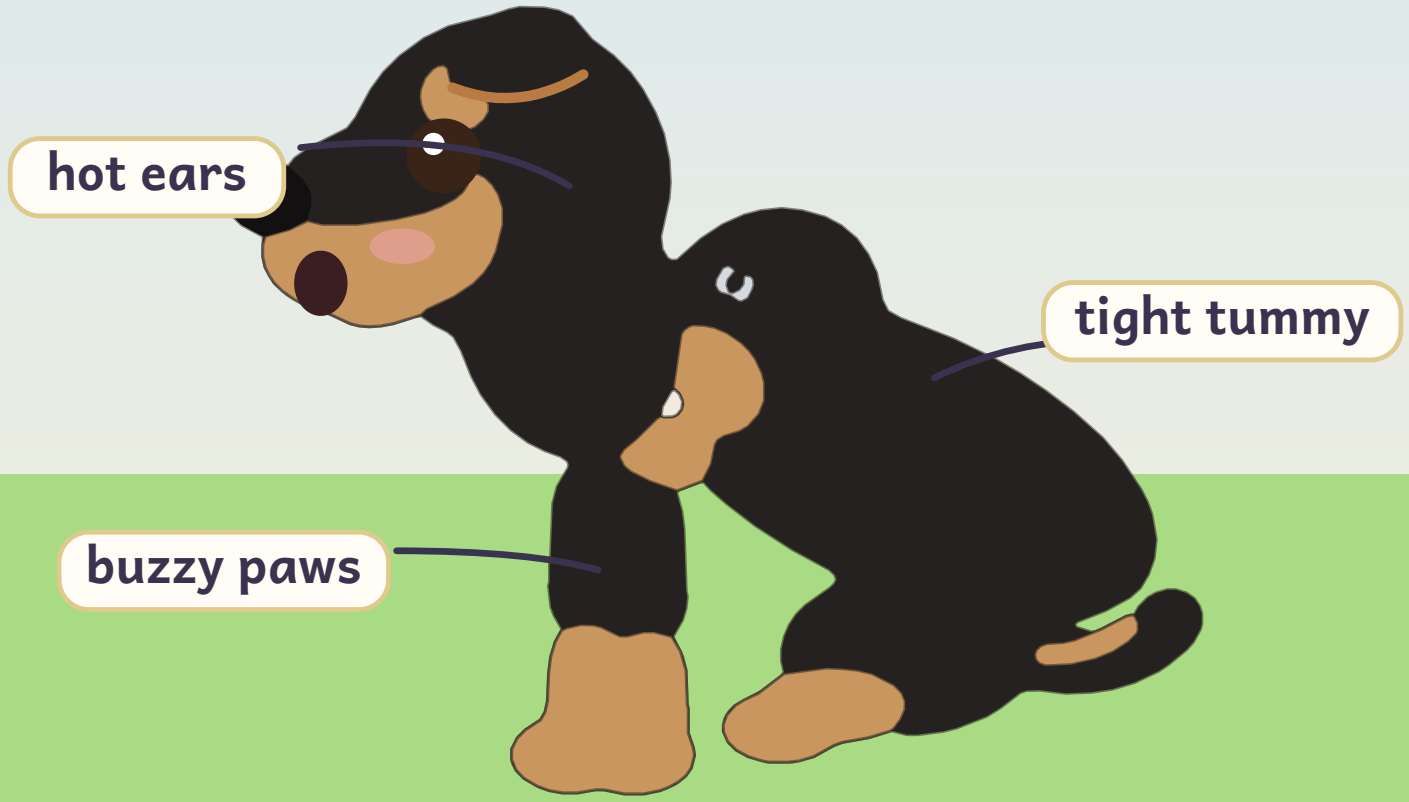


A little gray cloud floated in through the door.
“Grumble,” it said. “Grumble, grumble, grrr.”
That was Grumble, a cloud of Static.
Static is only noisy feelings, floating about.

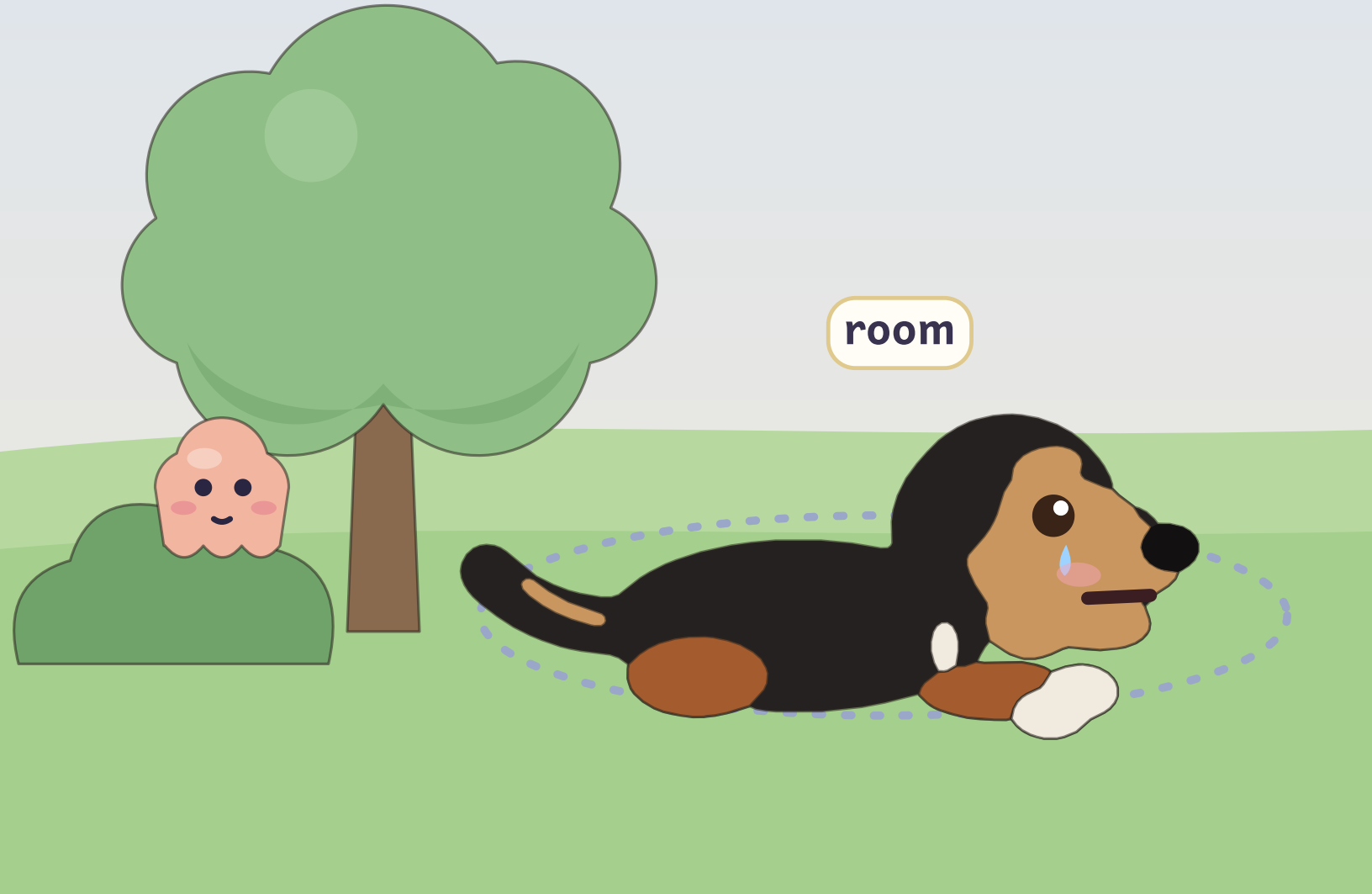
Professor Puddles came pitter-pattering by,
with his round little glasses and his hat held high.
“Good morning!” he said.
“What is your body telling you?”



Tidbit stopped. She checked.
“Buzzy paws. Hot ears. A tight little tummy.”
“Ah,” said the Professor. “A revved-up engine.
Good noticing!”



Sugarfoot's body was telling her something else.
Heavy paws. Droopy ears. A quiet, empty tummy.
Mumble, the shy little cloud, hid behind the bush,
and Sugarfoot got very quiet too.



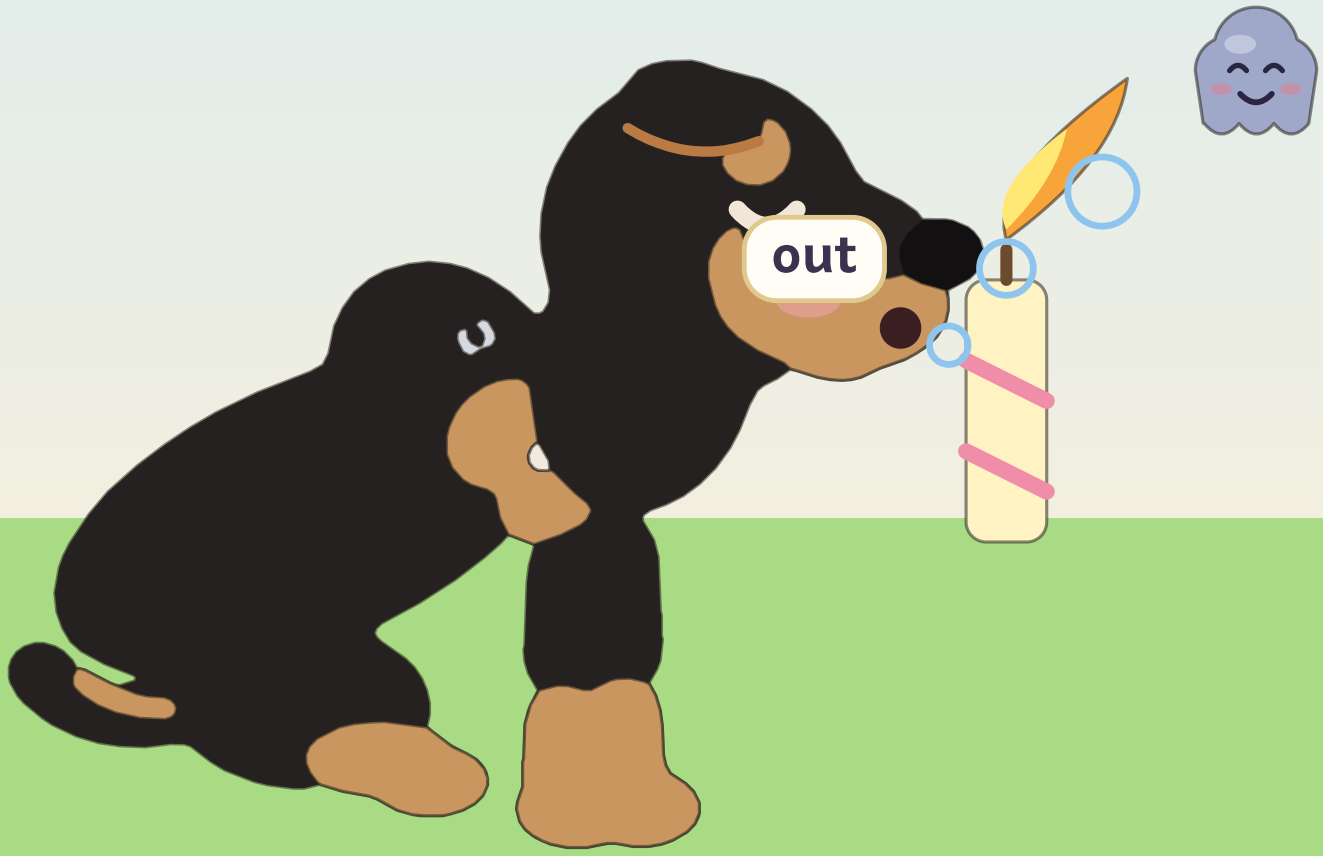
“I need some room,” said Sugarfoot.
“Just a little while. Then I would love a hug.”
Tidbit wanted to hug right away.
But she waited, one slow breath at a time.



“Try this,” said the Professor.
“Smell the flower, nice and slow.
Blow the candle, out and low.”



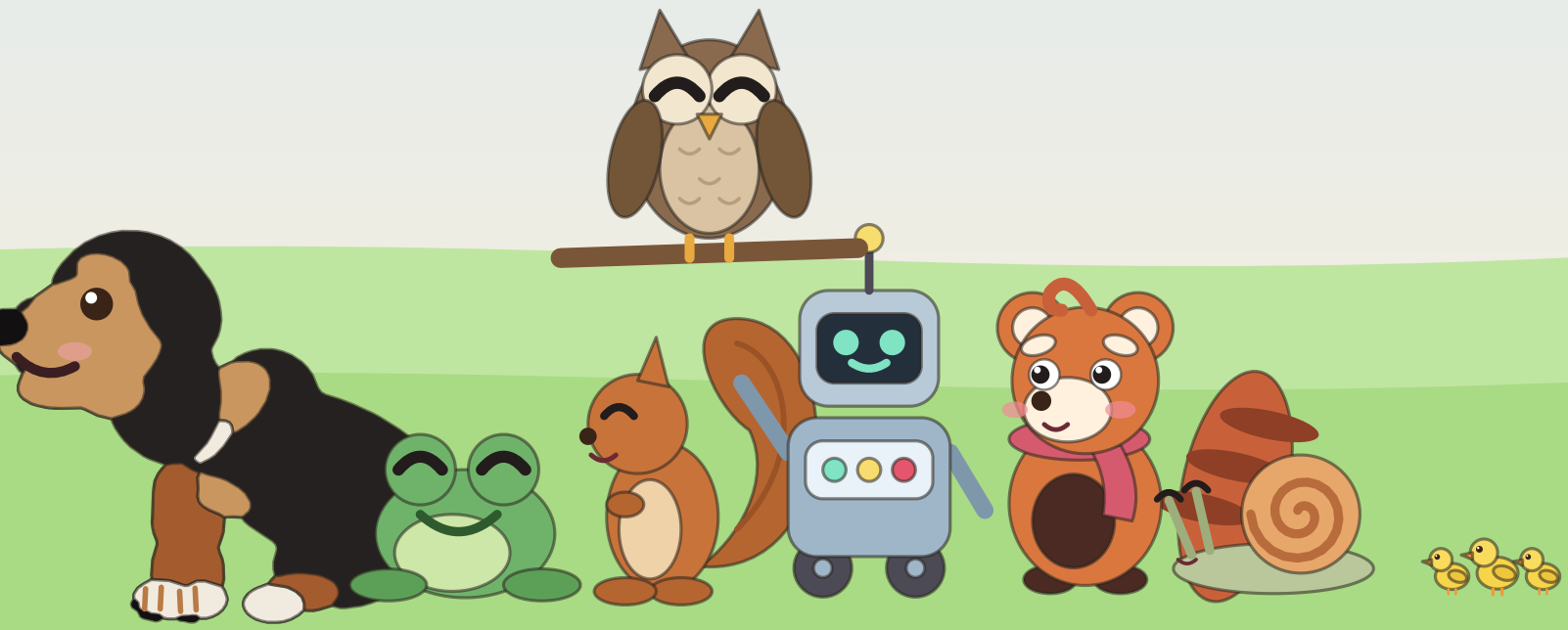
Tidbit smelled the flower.
Tidbit blew the candle.
Smell the flower. Blow the candle.
Her paws stopped buzzing. Her ears cooled down.
Grumble got smaller, and smaller, and smaller.



Sugarfoot was feeling better.
“Now I would love that hug,” she said,
and Tidbit gave it, gently, for a long, long time.
Then Tidbit did something brave.
“This basket is too heavy for me,” she said. “Can you help?”



“Yes!” said Sugarfoot.
“Yes!” said Hopper.
“Yes!” said Nutmeg, and Dot, and Ollie, and Lumi, and Beep,
and all three ducklings, who said it very small.



One job each. That is how it goes.
Beep took the blanket. Hopper took the apples.
Nutmeg took the nuts. The ducklings took the napkins,
one each.
Lumi lit the lantern path.



The basket was light as a dandelion.
Dot had the slowest job, the bag of cracker crumbs,
and nobody hurried her.
Slow is a speed too.

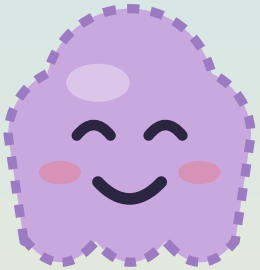


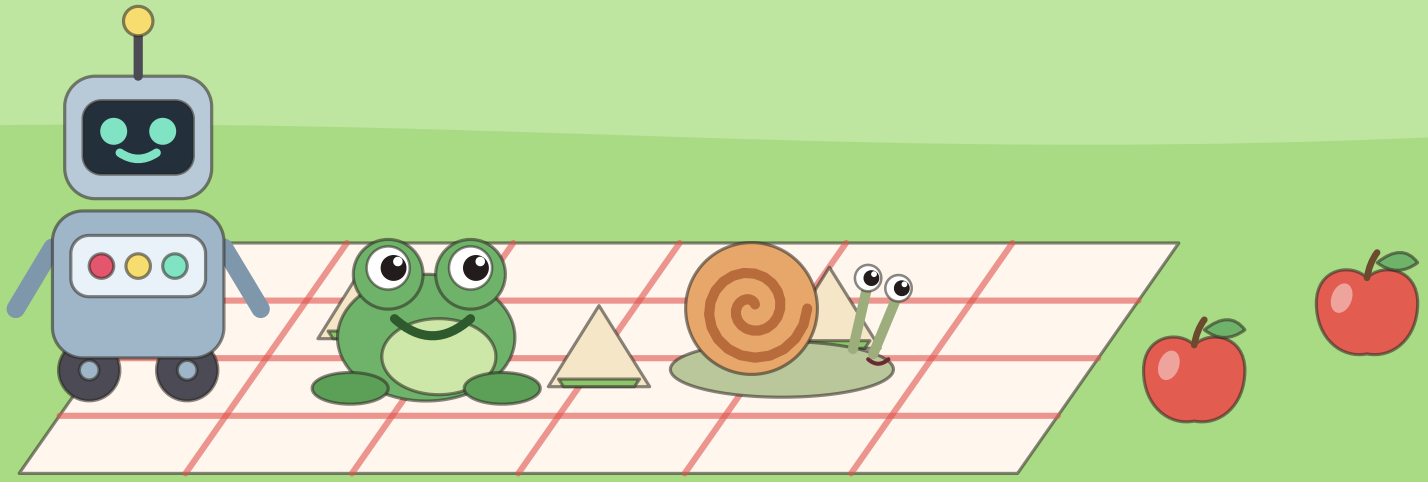
Then Tidbit saw a butterfly.
ZOOM! She forgot where her feet were.
She forgot where the basket was.
CRASH! BOOM! SPLAT!



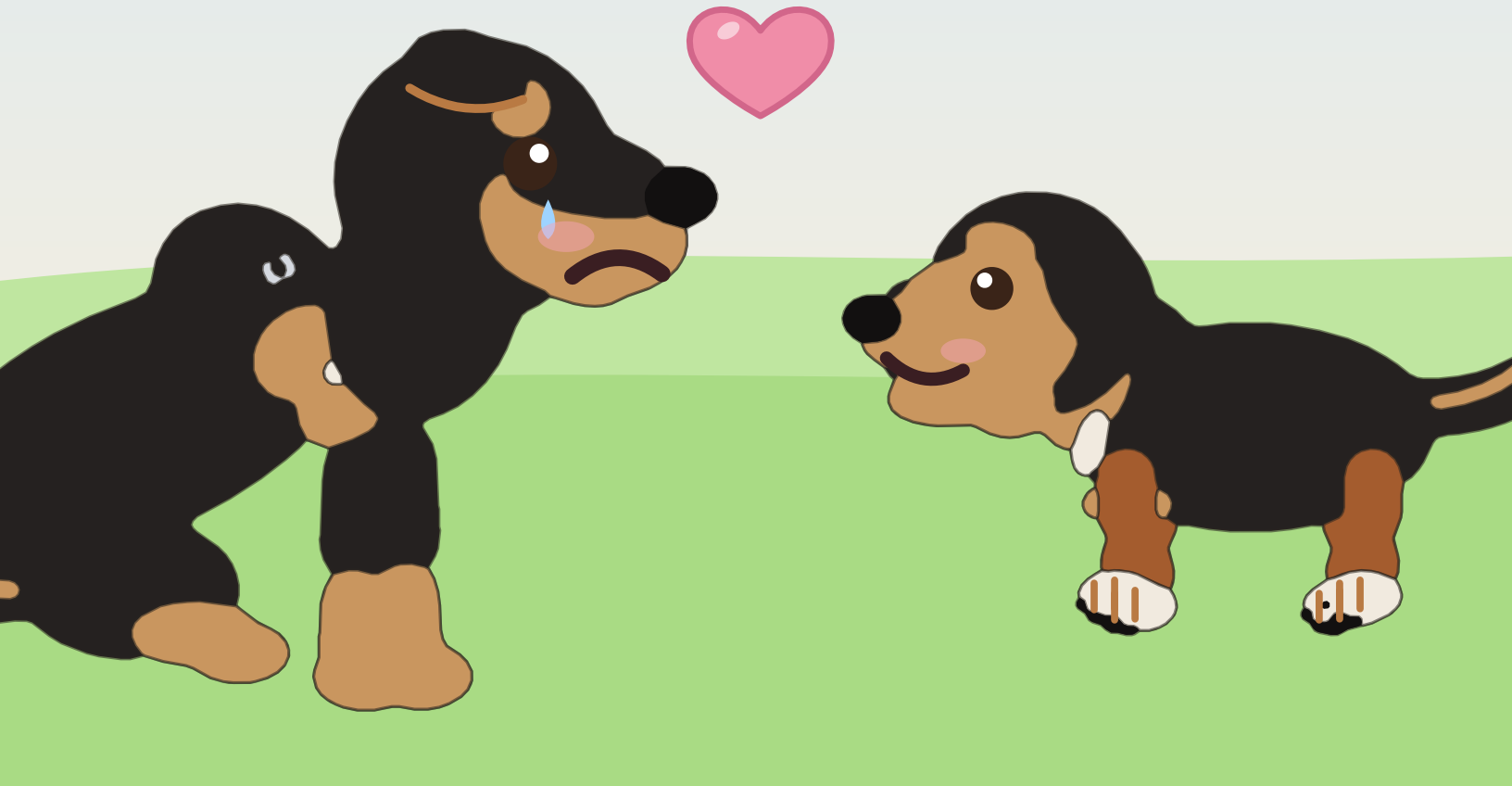
Apples rolled. The pie went flying.
The sandwiches squished flat as flat.
Everybody went quiet.
Fuzz, a fuzzy little cloud of Static, giggled.
Tidbit's tummy dropped.
"That was me," she whispered.



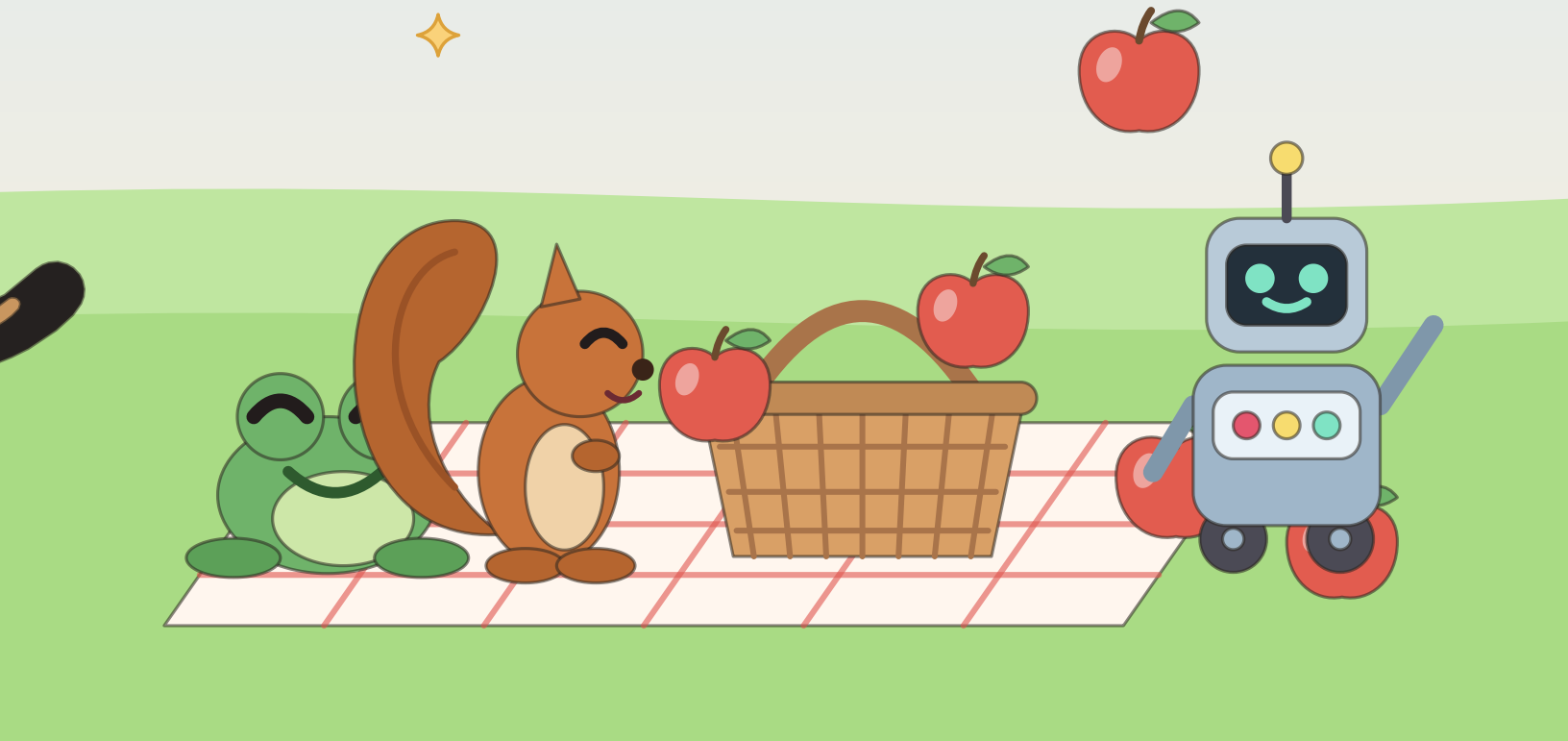




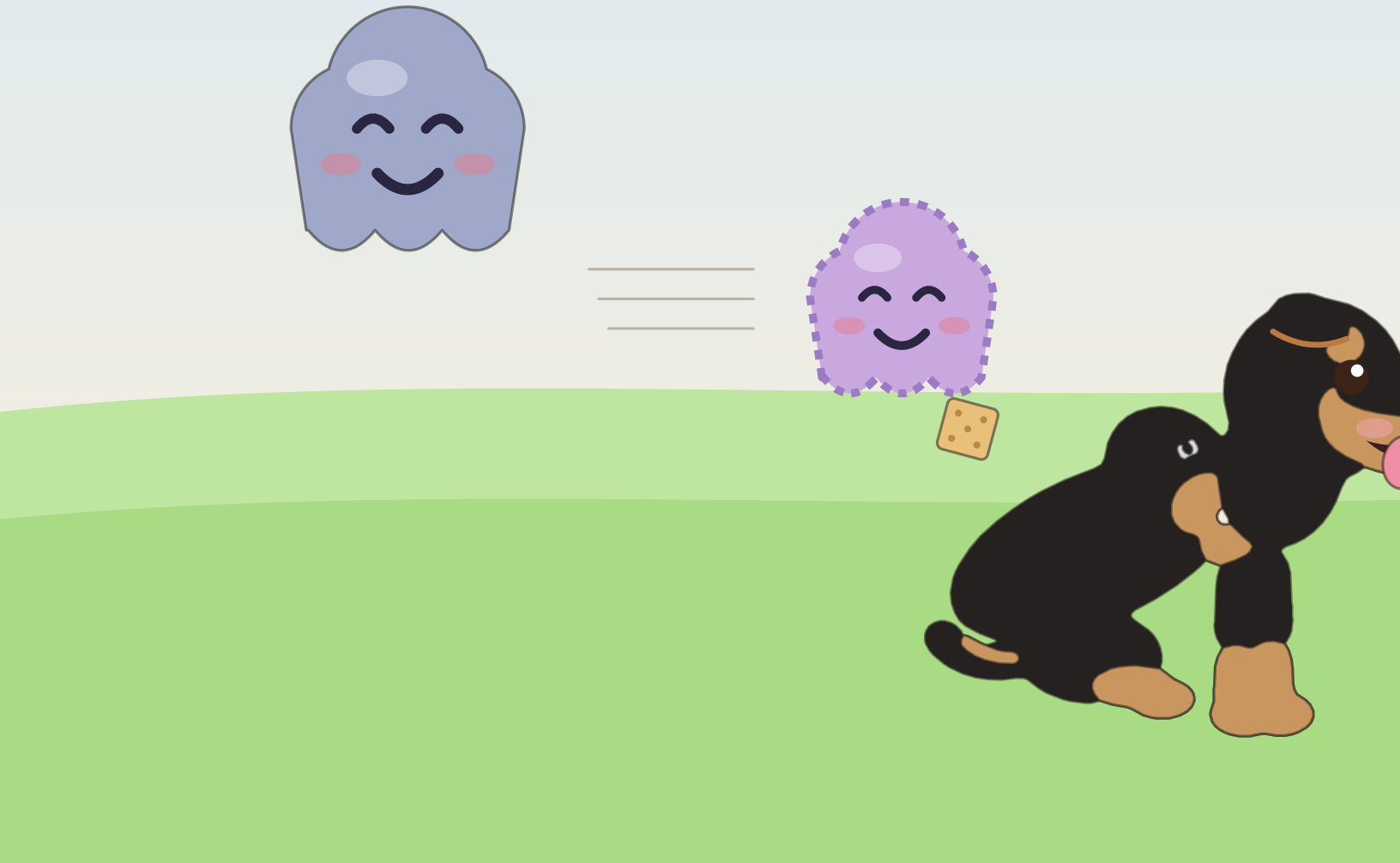
Tidbit took a slow breath.
“I’m sorry. I zoomed too fast and I knocked the basket.
That was my fault.
What can I do to make it right?”



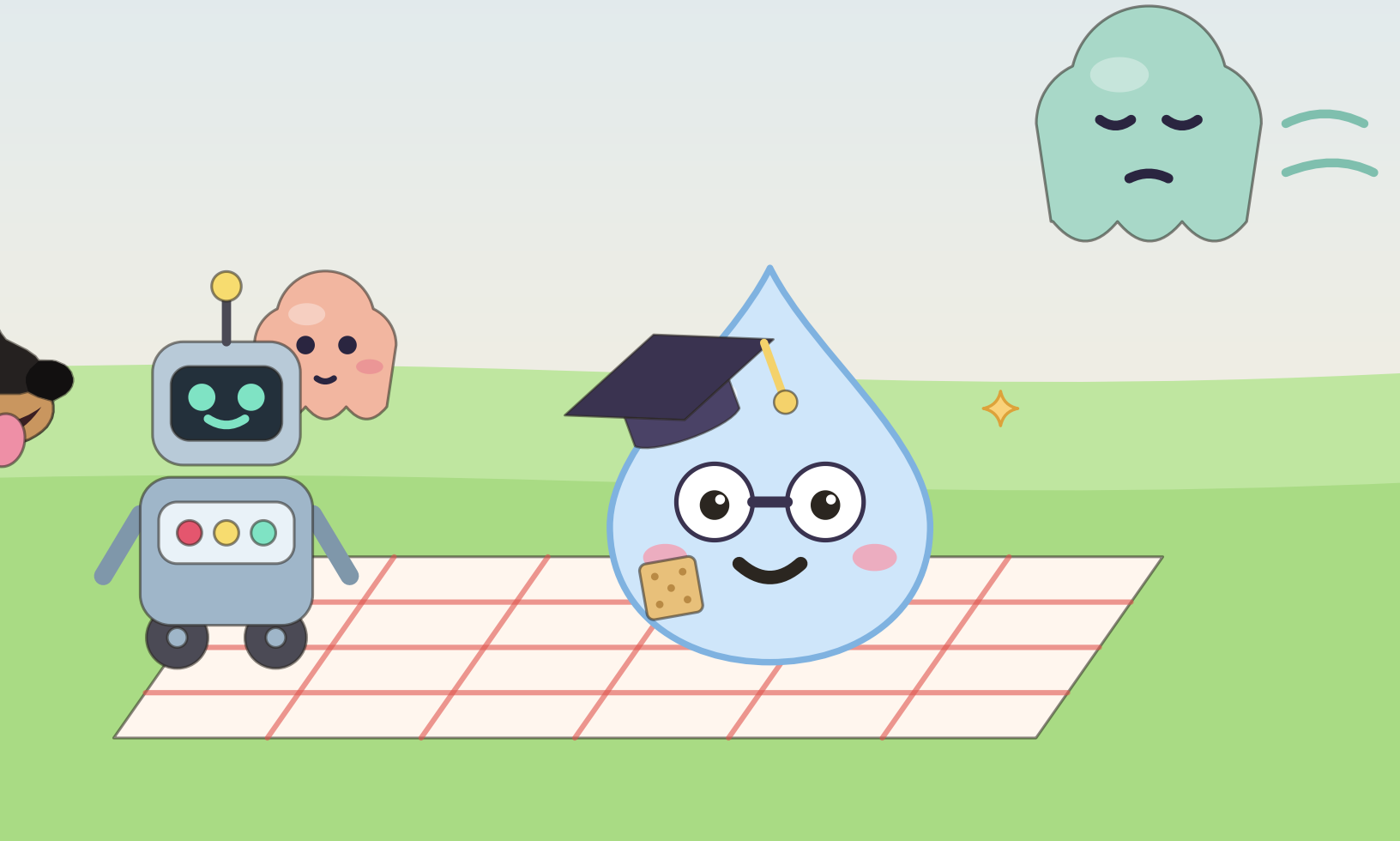
“Help us catch the apples,” said Hopper.
So she did. They all did.
The sandwiches were still yummy, just a little flat.
“Thank you for saying sorry,” said Sugarfoot.
“Next time I will look before I zoom,” said Tidbit.



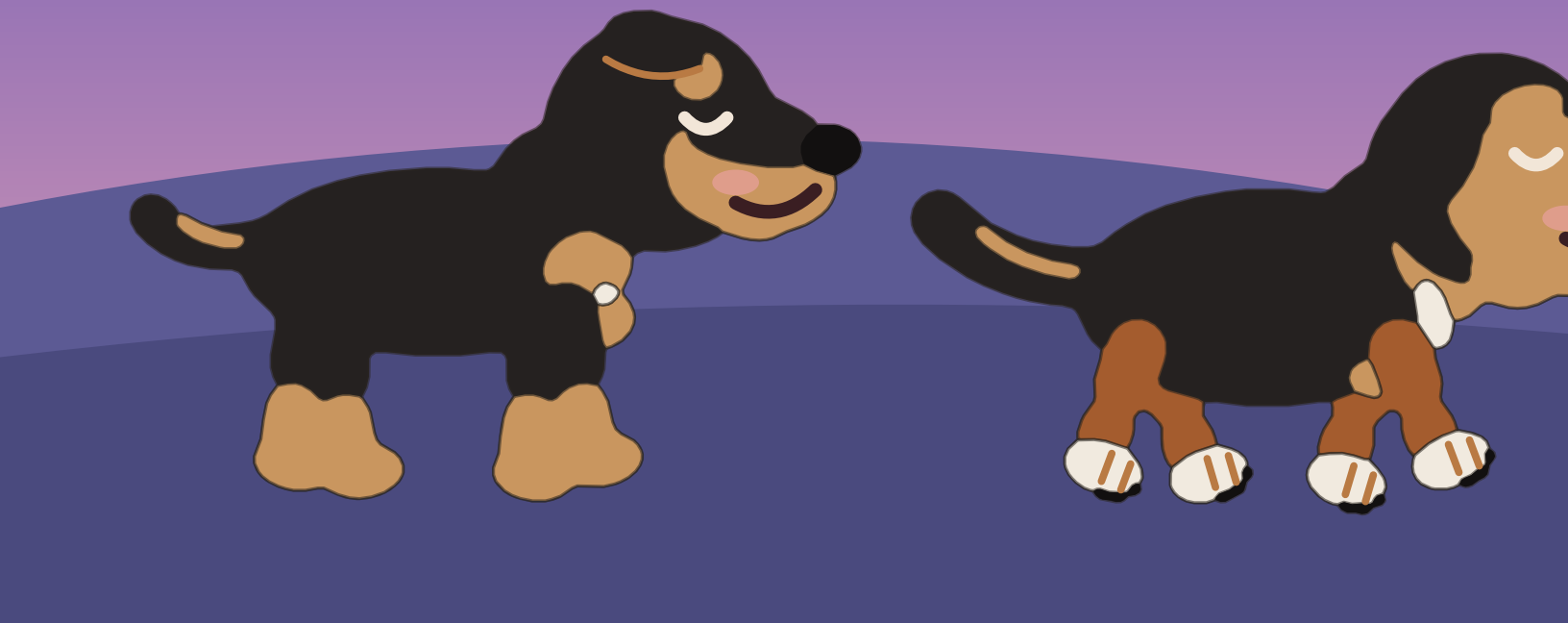
The clouds of Static drifted over to see.
Grumble grumbled a little less.
Fuzz grabbed a cracker and zipped away.
Mumble peeked out from behind Beep.



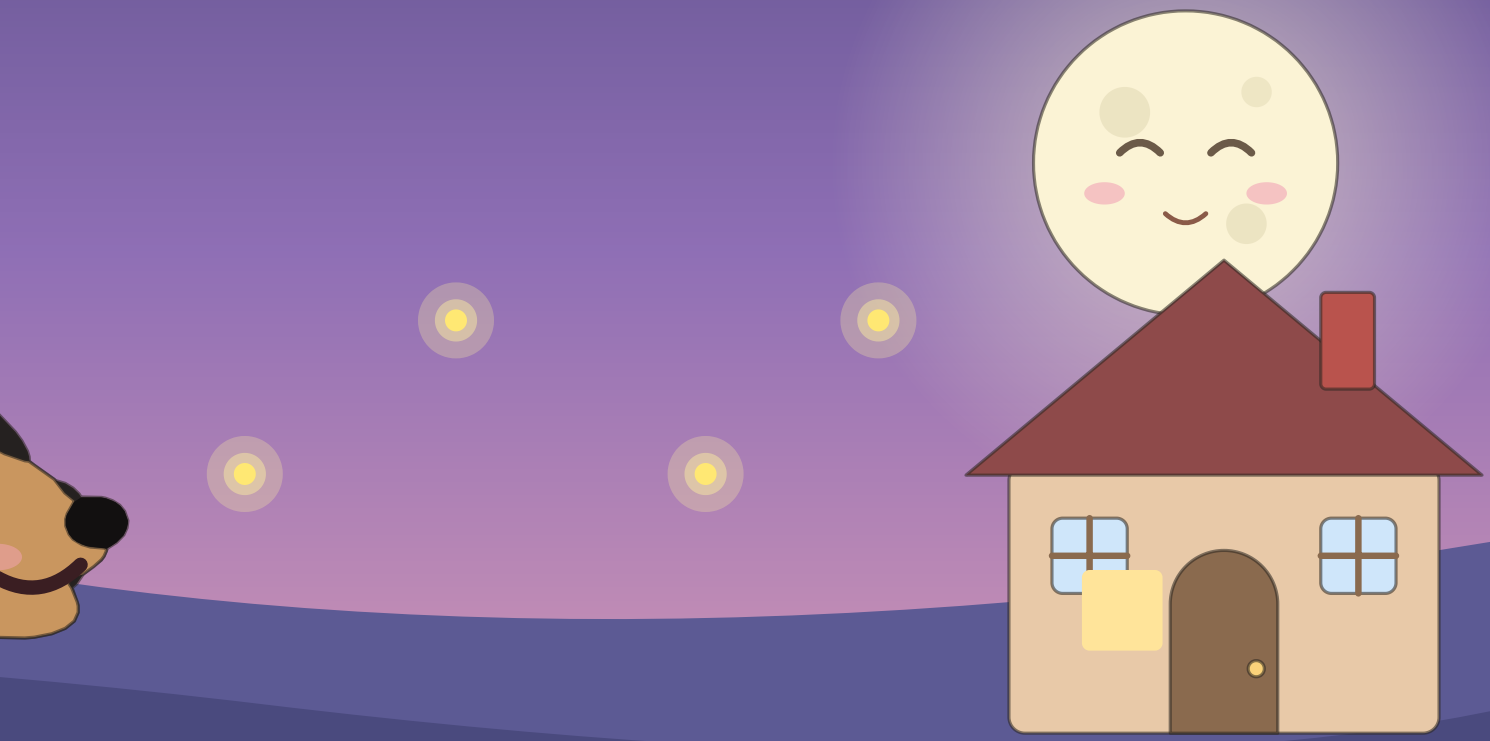
“Static is just loud feelings looking for a friend,”
said Professor Puddles.
Fuzz tiptoed back and put the cracker in the middle
as if nothing had happened.
Everybody laughed, even Grumble.



When the sun got low and the sky turned pink,
Tidbit gave a great big yawn.
“Can we walk home slow?” she asked.
“My legs want a slow walk.”



“Yes,” said Sugarfoot. “Slow it is.”
Fast and slow, side by side,
they walked home under the Moon.
“Goodnight, Tidbit. Goodnight, Sugarfoot.”
“Goodnight, Moon. Goodnight, everyone. Goodnight, Static.”



Smell the flower, blow the candle

1. Smell the flower

Breathe in slowly through your nose, like you are smelling a flower.

2. Blow the candle

Breathe out slowly through your mouth, like you are blowing a candle without putting it out too fast.

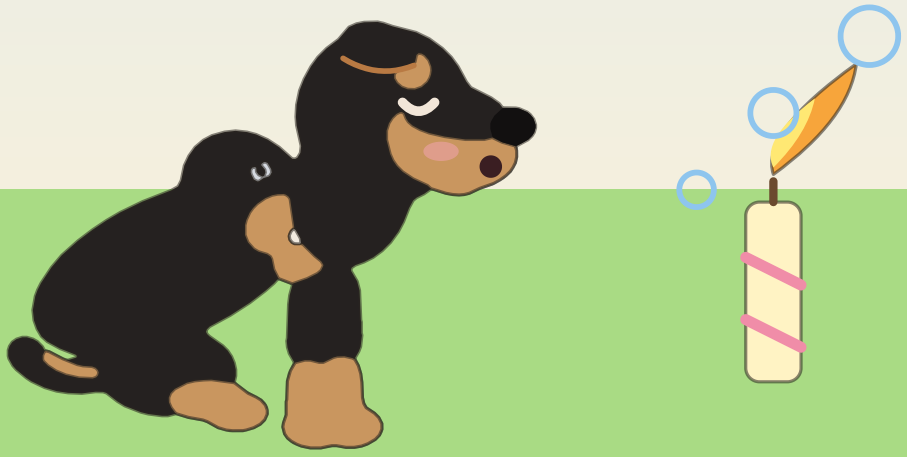


3. Do it again

Smell the flower. Blow the candle. Three times is plenty.

4. Ask your body

What is my body telling me? Buzzy, heavy, or calm?



For grown-ups

This story is built around four small skills that children (and adults) can practice any day: noticing what the body is saying, asking for what you need, sharing a load by giving everyone one job, and repairing after a mistake.

Tidbit is a revved-up engine: fast, buzzy, hot-eared. Sugarfoot is running on empty: slow, heavy, quiet. Neither one is the better way to be. Each needs something different, and each is easier to help once she says what it is.

The Static clouds stand for noisy feelings. They are never villains. They drift in when a body is wound up or worn out, and they settle when someone slows down and listens.

Read it slowly, and stop where it helps. Let children name what each character's body is telling them before the story does.





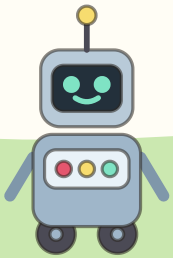


Talk about it

1. What was Tidbit's body telling her when the basket would not move? What about Sugarfoot's?
2. Sugarfoot asked for room first and a hug later. What helps you when you feel heavy or upset?
3. Everyone had one job. Which job would you pick? Which job would be too big for one person?
4. Tidbit said three things when she knocked the basket: sorry, what happened, and how to make it right. What would you say?
5. Dot had the slowest job and nobody hurried her. Is it okay to be slow? Is it okay to be fast?
6. When Static floats in, what could you try first? Smell the flower, blow the candle?







Words to try

When you need something

“I need some room, then *a* hug.”
“This is too heavy for me. Can you help?”
“Can we go slow?”

When you bump or break something

1. Say sorry.
2. Say what happened: “I zoomed too fast.”
3. Ask: “What can I do to make it right?”

When someone else is upset

“Do you want room, or do you want me close?”
“I can wait.”

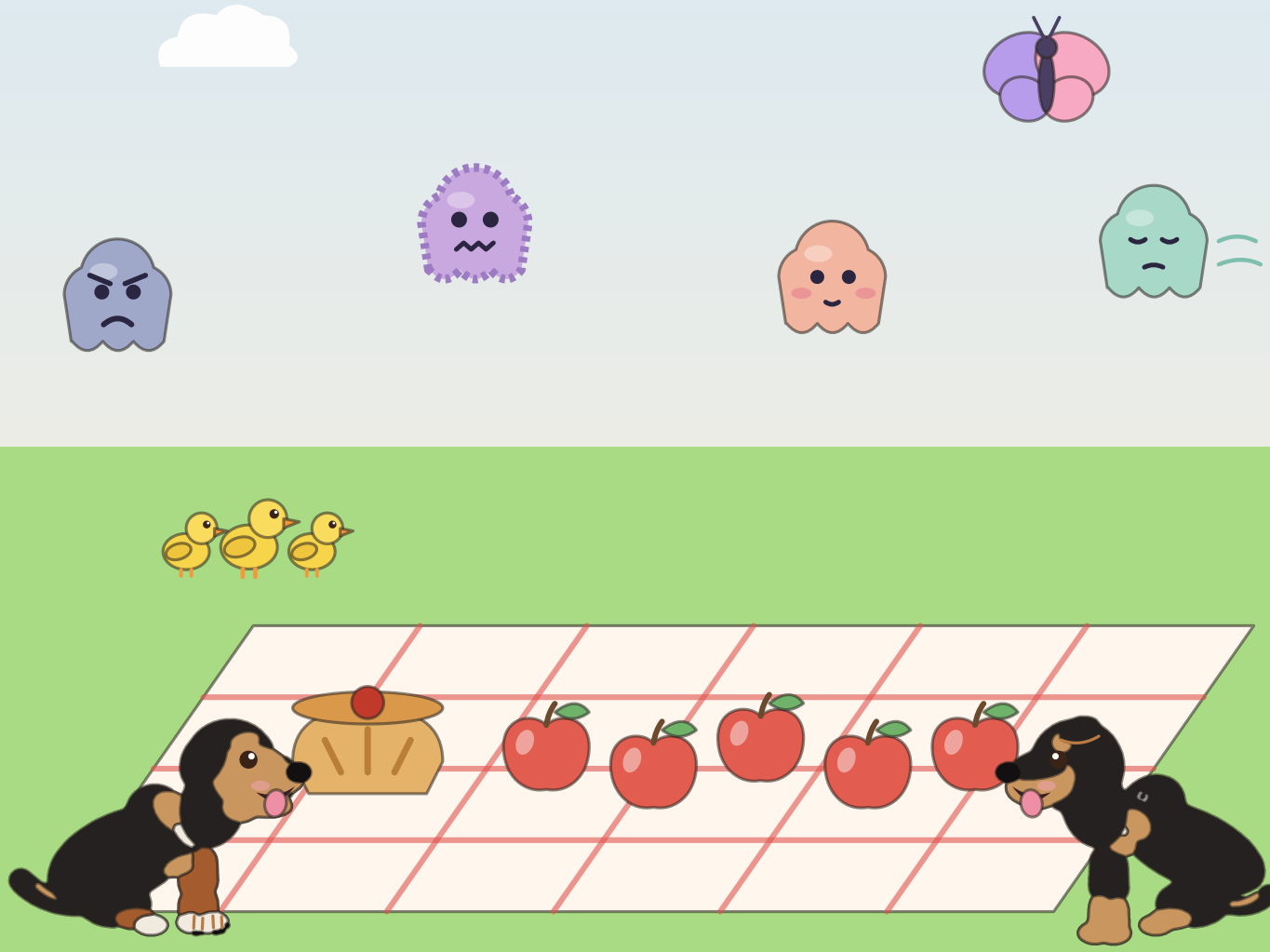






Find and count

3 ducklings · 4 clouds of Static · 1 butterfly · 5 apples · 1 pie · 2 pups



About this book

Tidbit and Sugarfoot live at spreadloveandacceptance.com, where they star in the Frequency Buddies cartoon, play games, and keep company in the Night Garden. Everything on the site is free to read and use.

There is a chapter book for ages 9 to 12 and two coloring books with the same friends.



The End

Goodnight, everyone.



Thank you for reading.

More at spreadloveandacceptance.com

